

Meridian State University

Admissions Policy

Undergraduate, Graduate, Transfer & International Admission Standards

Document Code: ADM-POL-101

Effective Date: August 1, 2026

Issuing Office: Office of the Registrar & Academic Affairs

Review Cycle: Annual

1. Purpose and Scope

This Admissions Policy governs the criteria, procedures, and timelines by which Meridian State University ("the University") evaluates and admits applicants to its undergraduate, graduate, and professional programs. It applies to all first-time freshmen, transfer students, readmitted students, non-degree visiting students, and international applicants.

The policy is designed to ensure that admissions decisions are made fairly, consistently, and in accordance with applicable federal and state non-discrimination laws. It does not cover financial aid eligibility, which is addressed separately in the Financial Aid and Fees Policy.

2. Undergraduate Admission Requirements

Applicants for first-time freshman admission must submit a completed application, an official high school transcript (or equivalent), and, where required by the specific program, standardized test scores. The Office of Admissions reviews each application holistically, considering academic performance, rigor of coursework, extracurricular involvement, and personal statements.

2.1 Minimum Academic Thresholds

Criterion	Minimum Requirement	Competitive Range
Cumulative GPA (unweighted)	2.75	3.4 – 4.0
Standardized Test (optional)	Not required	1180–1420 SAT / 24–32 ACT
Core Academic Units	16 units	18+ units with AP/IB/Honors
English Proficiency (Intl.)	TOEFL iBT 79 / IELTS 6.5	TOEFL iBT 100+ / IELTS 7.5+

Note: Meeting the minimum threshold does not guarantee admission; the University operates a holistic and selective review process for competitive programs such as Nursing and Computer Science.

3. Transfer Admission

Transfer applicants who have completed 24 or more transferable semester credit hours at a regionally accredited institution are evaluated primarily on their collegiate academic record. A minimum cumulative transfer GPA of 2.5 is required for general admission; select programs, including Engineering and Business, require a 3.0 minimum in prerequisite coursework.

- Official transcripts from every institution previously attended must be submitted directly to the Office of Admissions.
- A maximum of 90 semester credit hours may be transferred toward a bachelor's degree.
- Courses in which a grade below C- was earned are not eligible for transfer credit.
- Transfer credit evaluations are typically completed within 15 business days of receipt of official transcripts.

4. Graduate and Professional Admission

Graduate admission requires a bachelor's degree (or equivalent) from an accredited institution, a minimum cumulative GPA of 3.0 in the final 60 credit hours of undergraduate study, two to three letters of recommendation, a statement of purpose, and, for research-intensive programs, a writing sample or research proposal. Individual departments may impose additional requirements, including GRE, GMAT, or portfolio submissions, as published in the Graduate Catalog.

4.1 Provisional Admission

Applicants who do not meet the minimum GPA threshold but demonstrate strong potential through professional experience, recommendation letters, or improved performance in recent coursework may be admitted provisionally. Provisional students must earn a B or better in their first nine credit hours of graduate coursework to be converted to regular standing.

5. International Applicants

International applicants must demonstrate English proficiency through an approved standardized test unless exempted (e.g., completion of a degree taught in English or citizenship of an English-speaking country as defined by University policy). Upon admission, international students must submit financial documentation sufficient to cover one academic year of tuition, fees, and living expenses before Form I-20 or DS-2019 is issued.

- Credential evaluation through a NACES-member agency is required for degrees earned outside the United States.
- Conditional admission with concurrent English-language coursework is available through the Intensive English Program.
- International transfer students must additionally submit a SEVIS transfer-in form from their prior institution.

6. Application Deadlines and Decision Timelines

Term	Priority Deadline	Final Deadline	Decision Released By
Fall (Freshman)	November 1	March 1	December 15 / April 1
Fall (Transfer)	April 1	July 1	May 1 / August 1
Spring (All)	October 1	December 1	November 1 / December 20
Summer (All)	March 1	May 1	April 1 / May 15

Applications received after the final deadline may be considered on a space-available basis at the discretion of the Office of Admissions.

7. Appeals and Reconsideration

Applicants who are denied admission may request a single reconsideration of their file within 30 calendar days of the decision notification. Reconsideration requests must include new information not previously available at the time of the original review, such as updated transcripts or test scores. The Admissions

Appeals Committee renders a final decision within 20 business days; its determination is final and not subject to further institutional appeal.

8. Frequently Asked Questions

Can I apply to more than one program at once?

Yes. Applicants may apply to up to two undergraduate programs or one graduate program per admission cycle. A separate application and, where applicable, supplemental materials are required for each.

What happens if my transcript arrives after the deadline?

Applications are considered complete only once all required transcripts are received. Late transcripts may delay review but will not automatically disqualify an otherwise timely application, provided the application itself was submitted by the stated deadline.

Are interviews required for admission?

Interviews are not required for general undergraduate admission but are a required component of select professional programs, including Nursing and the Honors College, as noted in their program-specific requirements.

9. Related Policies and Resources

This policy should be read in conjunction with other governing University policies, including the University Catalog, the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) Notice, and any college- or department-specific handbooks that supplement, but do not contradict, the standards set out here. Where a conflict exists between this policy and a college-level document, this policy governs unless an explicit written exception has been approved by the Provost's Office.

- University Catalog (undergraduate and graduate editions), published annually
- FERPA Notice of Student Rights, available through the Office of the Registrar
- Student Handbook, distributed at orientation and available online
- College- and department-specific supplemental guidelines, where applicable

10. Contact and Further Assistance

Questions regarding the interpretation or application of this policy should be directed to the Office of Admissions. Students are encouraged to reach out early in the process, as many concerns can be resolved informally before they require a formal procedure.

Contact Point	Detail
Office	Office of Admissions
Email	admissions@meridianstate.edu
Phone	(555) 201-4400

Contact Point	Detail
Office Hours	Monday–Friday, 8:30 a.m. – 5:00 p.m.
Walk-in Location	Student Services Building, Suite 200

11. Policy Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Changes
1.0	August 2021	Initial policy adopted by the Board of Trustees.
1.1	August 2023	Clarified procedural timelines and appeal deadlines.
2.0	August 2025	Comprehensive revision to align with updated accreditation standards.
2.1	August 2026	Minor updates for the current academic year; see effective date above.

Note: This document supersedes all prior versions upon its effective date. Archived versions are available upon request from the issuing office.